4.2 MORTAR

Learning Objectives

4.2 MORTAR

At the end of this lesson you shall be able to

- Know mortar and its types.
- Understand the properties of good mortar.
- Understand the preparation of cement mortar.
- Know the precaution in using mortar.
- Know the uses of mortar.

4.2.1 Introduction

Mortars are used in masonry for joining stones, bricks, blocks, etc., and are designated by the mix used.

4.2.2 Definition

The term mortar is used to indicate a paste prepared by adding required quantity of water to a mixture of binding material like cement or lime and fine aggregate like sand.



4.2.3 Properties of Good Mortar

i) It must have the required strength.

ii) It must be workable.

iii) It must be durable.

iv) Compatible with the types of painting work.

v) It should stiffen early.

vi) It must have good bond with bricks and stones.

vii) It should prevent seepage of rain water.

viii) It should be cheap.

ix) It should have water retentivity.

4.2.4 Types of Mortar

Based on the kind of binding material used, the mortar is classified into 4 types. The binding material is chosen based on the expected working condition, hardening temperature, moisture condition, etc.

They are,

1. Lime Mortar
2. Cement mortar
3. Combination or gauged mortar
4. Mud mortar

4.2.4.1 Lime Mortar

In lime mortar, lime is used as binding material and it may be fat lime, hydraulic

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